

Pop the Bubble — Judging Rubric

How we score. **Evidence over promises.** Every team is scored out of **90 core points** — a 30-point baseline applied to everyone, plus a 60-point block specific to your chosen track — with up to **+20 bonus** on top. **Maximum 110.**

Point distribution

Block	Points	Applies to
Baseline	30	every team
Track-specific	60	your chosen track
Core total	90	
Bonus	up to +20	every team, additive
Maximum	110	

Within a track, the three criteria always sum to **60**. The bonus is identical across all three tracks.

Baseline — 30 pts (every team)

Does it actually work — 10 pts

- **0** — slides or mockup only
- **4** — core flow runs locally
- **7** — deployed and reachable by judges
- **10** — judges complete the full flow end-to-end themselves

Depth of proof — 12 pts

- **0** — claims only, no artifacts
- **4** — one verifiable artifact
- **8** — ≥ 3 artifacts across ≥ 2 types (e.g. revenue + usage logs)
- **12** — every headline claim traces to a dated, independently checkable source

Honesty — 8 pts

- **8** — every claim checks out

- **4** — minor unverifiable claims, nothing inflated
 - **0** — an unverifiable headline claim
 - *Fabrication is subject to disqualification.*
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Track 01 · Outbuild — 60 pts

Rebuild a bloated or broken product and take its users.

Better than the incumbent — 25 pts

- **0** — no comparison
- **8** — better, but unmeasured
- **16** — $\geq 25\%$ improvement on a measured primary metric (speed, cost, steps, or error rate)
- **25** — $\geq 50\%$ on a measured metric users care about, reproducible by judges

Real users switched — 20 pts

- **0** — nobody left the incumbent for your version
- **8** — a handful of early switchers, lightly evidenced
- **14** — a real cluster of users actively choosing your version over the incumbent
- **20** — clear, evidenced migration: multiple active users who've stuck with it, usage data shown

Revenue / willingness to pay — 15 pts

- **0** — no evidence anyone will pay
 - **5** — soft signal: verbal interest, waitlist, unpaid signups
 - **10** — hard commitment: card on file, signed LOI, or pre-order from a real customer
 - **15** — paying customers: real money collected from more than one user, receipts shown
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Track 02 · Validate — 60 pts

Build the evidence pack that exposes where a company's story doesn't hold.

Rigour & credibility — 25 pts

- **0** — assertions, no verifiable backing
- **8** — a case is made, but the method is opaque or not reproducible
- **16** — sound, transparent method a third party could re-run to the same result
- **25** — airtight: data and steps fully shared, conclusions reproducible, sourced so the target company itself couldn't credibly refute it

Significance of the truth — 20 pts

- **0** — trivial or already well known

- **8** — matters to a single team or product line
- **14** — matters to the whole company
- **20** — matters across the market, with the materiality shown

Decision-maker proof — 15 pts

- **0** — raw notes or a data dump
 - **6** — a clear, readable writeup
 - **11** — a decision-ready artifact (one-pager, dashboard, report) a named role could act on today
 - **15** — decision-ready *and* put in front of / acknowledged by a relevant decision-maker
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Track 03 · Effect — 60 pts

Remove a recurring burden WITH a named person or org — then get paid.

Burden actually removed — 25 pts

- **0** — none
- **8** — burden documented, partial relief
- **16** — $\geq 50\%$ reduction in the recurring task for one cycle
- **25** — sustained relief the user confirms

Money changed hands — 20 pts

- **0** — no money
- **7** — committed to pay: signed or card on file
- **13** — paid once: a real transaction with the named beneficiary
- **20** — a paying relationship: repeat or ongoing payment, not a one-off token

Genuine collaboration — 15 pts

- **0** — built in a vacuum, no contact
 - **6** — talked to them once, took the brief
 - **11** — worked with them through the build; their feedback visibly changed direction
 - **15** — a true working partnership: continuous loop, and they co-validate the final result
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Bonus — up to +20 pts (additive, capped)

Build in public — up to +12 pts

- **+2** per substantive, dated public post that shows real progress
- ~6 posts to reach the cap
- Real moments beat polished marketing.

- **Tag us to make it count.** Posts must tag the organisers so we can verify and amplify them — **Aruzhan first** (most likely to see and reshare), then the rest, then the sponsor accounts:
 - Instagram: [@popthebubble.hack](#)
 - X: [@arukanism](#) · [@zmzlois](#) · [@Lantos1618](#) · [@dimplnotsimpl](#)
 - LinkedIn: [Aruzhan](#) · [Lyndon](#) · [Lois](#) · [Alramina](#)

Meaningful Mubit SDK use — up to +10 pts

- **up to +4** — bolted-on use
 - **up to +10** — core dependency: the product genuinely relies on Mubit's operational memory, judge-verified
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How scoring works

- **Total = baseline (30) + your track block (60) + bonus (≤ 20).**
- Each criterion is scored to the **highest band you fully meet** — a partial claim earns the band below.
- Every point above zero must be backed by evidence in your submission. Unverified claims score as the band below.
- **Honesty is scored, but fabrication is disqualification — not a low score.**
- Pick **one** track; it determines which 60-point block you're judged on. The baseline and bonus are the same for everyone.